

11.2.2 Different font sizes

For text content that is of a similar nature, that is, headers, footers, and body text, don't mess with the font sizes. If one header is a size 14 bold, make sure all your other headers are size 14 bold. Also, don't mess with the text formatting. If the body text for one section is left aligned, it is better to keep the body text of similar sections also left aligned. And obviously, get your grammar right.

11.2.3 Too many GIFs, moving elements

Yes, yes we know moving smileys are cool, but it is not necessary to have your whole page full of them. GIFs also take longer to load, and can just put people off. It is also not advisable to replace text with GIFs or



Too much animation is a big no-no

other animations, as this is often confusing—and selection of obscure and unclear images will leave people wondering what the hell it was they clicked on.

11.2.4 Flash follies

Flash is a brilliant design-content tool for your Web site, but there is a tendency to overuse it. Too much Flash in places where simple HTML would have done the trick is, well, simply annoying. Also, there are some finer points that one should keep in mind when designing in Flash. Like having a Skip Intro button if your site has a Flash intro. Or having a Sound On/Off button if there is background music.

11.2.5 Uncommon link colours

It's not a good idea to use non-standard colours for links. Obviously, one must colour visited and unvisited links separately, the latter being decidedly brighter than the former. Blues and greens are generally accepted colours for unvisited links, while reds and purples suit visited links best. Not underlining links is another cause of user irritation as one has to guess or scrub the page for a link.